

Peer Review & Feedback

Sharpen your project before the final showcase through structured peer feedback focused on **clarity, evidence, and impact**. This process will provide you with actionable insights to transform your good Capstone into a **polished, professional presentation**.



Why Peer Review Matters

1

Identify Blind Spots

After weeks of development, you're too close to your own infrastructure to see what's missing or unclear.

2

Simulate Stakeholder Questions

Practice answering the tough questions stakeholders will ask in real-world implementation scenarios.

3

Benchmark Against Peers

See how your solution compares to others, identifying competitive advantages and improvement areas.

4

Build Professional Skills

Develop the critical collaboration and constructive critique abilities essential in tech leadership roles.



Peer Review Framework

Technical Lens

Is the infrastructure reliable, scalable, and secure?

- Architecture decisions justified
- Failure modes addressed
- Technical debt minimized

Evidence Lens

Do metrics and benchmarks prove your claims?

- Performance tests documented
- Clear before/after metrics
- Dashboards showing real data

Impact Lens

Is business value clear and compelling?

- ROI calculations presented
- Stakeholder benefits explicit
- Problem-solution fit demonstrated

Feedback Rubric Template

Area	Key Questions	Rating (1-5)	Notes
Architecture	Clear? Scalable? HA included?		
Monitoring	SLOs measurable? Dashboards clear?		
Benchmarks	Latency/throughput proven?		
Security	IAM, RBAC, drift governance?		
Business Value	ROI, cost savings clear?		
Presentation	Story clear? Visuals effective?		

This structured format ensures comprehensive, consistent feedback across all critical project dimensions.

Giving Good Feedback

Be Specific

Not "dashboards are weak" but "add SLO gauges to your main monitoring dashboard to make performance thresholds immediately visible"

Balance Praise + Critique

Start with strengths before addressing improvements—this builds receptivity and acknowledges effort

Focus on Impact

Address how changes will improve stakeholder understanding or project outcomes, not personal preferences

Suggest Concrete Fixes

Offer actionable solutions, not just criticism: "Consider adding a cost comparison table between current and proposed architecture"



Receiving Feedback Effectively



Listen First

Resist the urge to defend or explain immediately. Absorb the feedback completely before responding.



Ask Clarifying Questions

"Can you show me exactly where the architecture diagram was unclear?" or "What specific metrics would make my case stronger?"



Prioritize Strategically

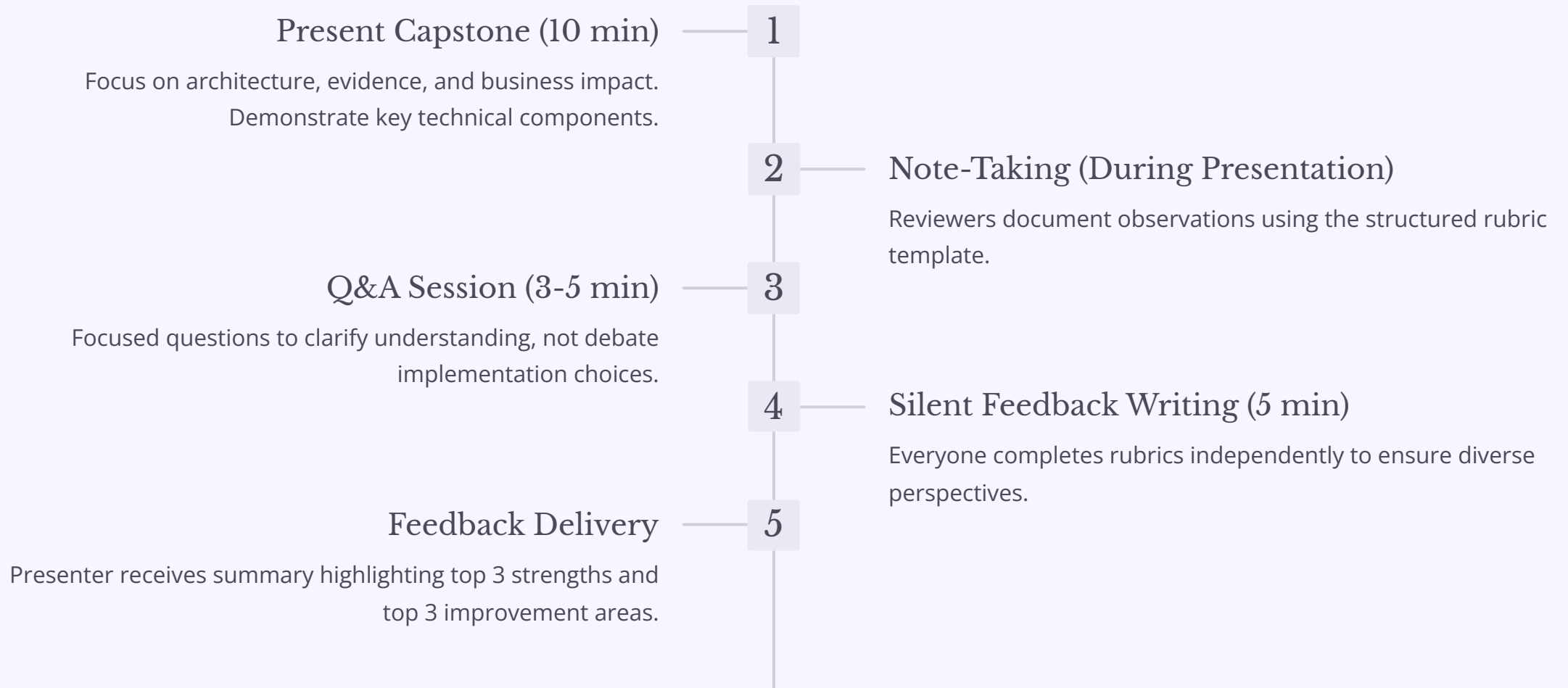
Focus on [high-impact, low-effort](#) changes first. Create an action plan for more complex improvements.



Express Appreciation

Thank reviewers specifically for their most helpful insights—this builds a culture of trust and continuous improvement.

Peer Review Session Flow



Example Peer Feedback: Case Study

✓ Strengths

- High-availability design clearly illustrated with regional failover diagram
- Stress test results convincingly demonstrate 3x throughput improvement
- Monitoring dashboards are polished and show real-time alerting thresholds

ⓘ Improvements

- Add configuration drift report screenshot to security section
- Business ROI slide too dense—break into cost savings vs. performance gains
- Simplify IAM diagram by focusing on key roles rather than all permissions

Impact Assessment: "With these specific tweaks, this project would impress enterprise CTOs with its [balance of technical depth and business clarity](#)."



Miro or Mural boards for quick post-it style feedback organized by project component



Optional Google or Microsoft Forms for candid feedback on sensitive improvement areas

Incorporating Feedback Effectively

Categorize Feedback

Sort feedback into [quick wins](#) vs. [major fixes](#) based on effort required and impact on presentation quality.

Quick Wins (1-2 hours)

- Add legend to architecture diagram
- Reorder slides (problem → demo → ROI)
- Add executive summary slide
- Include glossary for technical terms
- Enhance visual hierarchy in dashboards

Major Fixes (4+ hours)

- Gather additional benchmark evidence
- Enhance IAM/RBAC documentation
- Create before/after cost comparison
- Develop technical debt roadmap
- Add failure scenario walkthroughs

Final Peer Review Checklist

Complete Feedback Collection

All peers have provided rubric-based feedback with specific ratings and comments

Strengths & Improvements Identified

Clear documentation of what works well and what needs enhancement

Feedback Prioritization

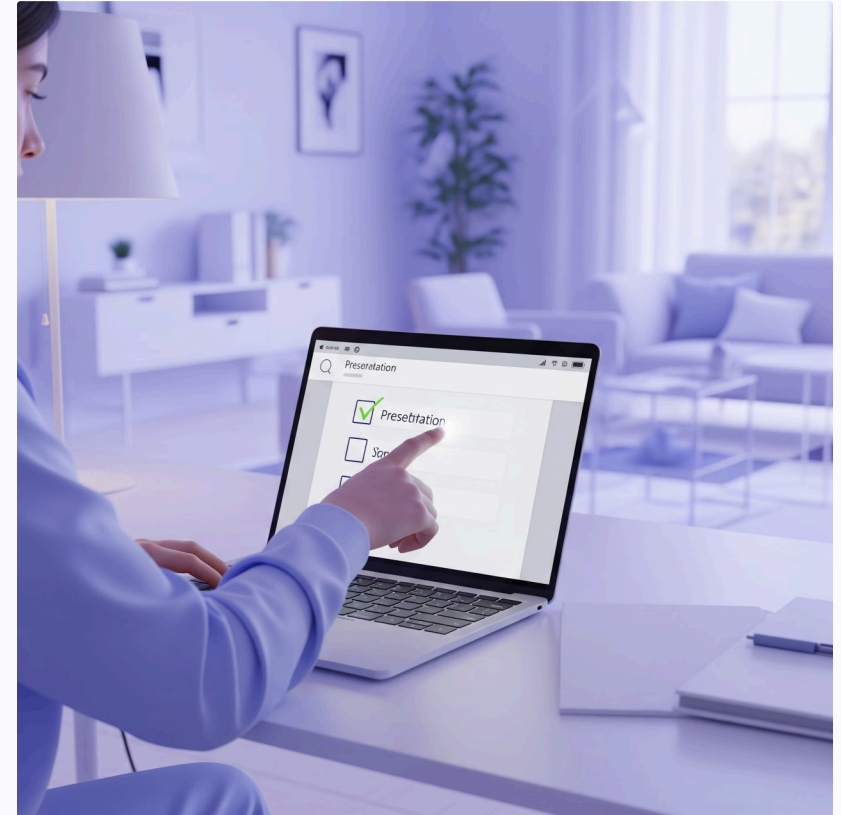
Presenter has acknowledged feedback and created a prioritized improvement plan

Implementation Verification

At least 2 significant improvements have been integrated into the final presentation

Peer Sign-Off

Reviewers have confirmed that critical issues have been addressed in the final version



Summary: The Power of Peer Review

B

Builds Confidence

When peers validate your work, you present with greater assurance and credibility



Ensures Fair Assessment

Structured rubrics focus feedback on objective criteria rather than personal preferences



Balances Perspectives

Technical depth, evidence quality, and business impact receive equal consideration



Polishes Your Capstone

Incorporating peer insights transforms good work into exceptional final presentations

The peer review process is not just about improving your current Capstone—it's building the professional skills you'll use throughout your career.

Discussion: Finding the Right Balance

"When reviewing a peer's Capstone, would you focus more on technical depth or business clarity — and why?"

Consider how different stakeholders (technical teams vs. business leadership) will evaluate the project, and how your review can help your peer communicate effectively with both audiences.

